Nehru's visit to Mexico in 1961 and Indira Gandhi's visit to 8 Latin American and Carribean nations in 1968.

Relations at present

India and Brazil are the two components of BRICS which was formed in 2006. This getting together of Brazil-Russia-India-China and South Africa (BRICS) has provided a platform for India to actively engage with Latin America and Carribean. The grouping of these emerging nations of the world facilitates greater economic and cultural exchange between India and Latin America and Carribean. The 2014 BRICS summit in Brazil enabled the Indian Prime Minister to hold meetings with other Latin America and Carribean leaders on the sidelines.

With a population of about 620 million and a resource-rich land, Latin America and Carribean presents itself as a great opportunity for India to expand its global footprint. With the advancement of technology and transport mechanisms, the geographical distance can be narrowed to facilitate deeper engagement. History of friendly relations between Latin America and Carribean and India also provides a foundation for enhanced cooperation in the 21st century.

9.8 India and Regional Organisations

SAARC (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation)

SAARC was established on 8 December 1985 with the signing of the SAARC Charter in Dhaka to promote economic cooperation and development, the welfare of the people and for the close cultural and historical links among the South Asian Countries. SAARC comprises of eight Member States: Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan and Sri Lanka. The Secretariat of the Association was set up in Kathmandu on 17 January 1987.

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Activity



The reason why South Asia is the least integrated region in the World is because the economic linkages are very weak among the countries of the region. Discuss with your pair.

The objectives of the Association are:

- To promote the welfare of the peoples of South Asia and to improve their quality of life.
- To accelerate economic growth, social progress and cultural development in the region and to provide all individuals with the opportunity to live in dignity and to realize their full potentials.

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